request. For example, you can update the Create Space operation to check that the “owner” field matches the currently authenticated user. This also allows us to skip validating the username, because you can rely on the registration service to have done that for us. Open the SpaceController.java file in your editor and change the createSpace method to check that the owner of the space matches the authenticated subject, as in the following snippet:

```
  public JSONObject createSpace(Request request, Response
response) {
    ..
    var owner = json.getString("owner");
    var subject = request.attribute("subject");
    if (!owner.equals(subject)) {
      throw new IllegalArgumentException(
          "owner must match authenticated user");
    }
    ..
  }
```

You could in fact remove the owner field from the request and always use the authenticated user subject, but for now you’ll leave it as it is. You can do the same in the Post Message operation in the same file:

```
    var user = json.getString("author");
    if (!user.equals(request.attribute("subject"))) {
      throw new IllegalArgumentException(
          "author must match authenticated user");
    }
```